

Yazid ibn Mu'awiyah and his son, Historical Stories For Children 2



Compiled by Unknown

Al-Islam.org

Publisher(s):

[World Organization for Islamic Services \(WOFIS\)](#) [1]

The second book of the historical series for children pays attention to the vile character of Yazid the son of Mu'awiyah and the amazing character of his son Mu'awiyah. Yazid was the person responsible for the slaughter of our Imam Husayn (as) and the martyrs of Karbala. Unlike his grandfather and his father, the son of Yazid was a flower that flourished and bloomed in a heap of dirt.



[Get PDF](#) [2] [Get EPUB](#) [3] [Get MOBI](#) [4]

Topic Tags:

[History](#) [5]

Person Tags:

[Yazid b. Mu'awiya](#) [6]

Foreword

In the Name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful

Our aim for the publication of these series is to introduce some aspects of biography from the history of Islam. These biographies include both types of individuals who either played a good and useful role or a bad and harmful role. We had always cherished the idea that we would be able to produce a short sketch of hard facts from the history of Islam in this field to be written exclusively to capture the interest of young children and teenagers.

We pray to the Almighty Allah to assist us in proving our present and future efforts to be accomplished facts — thus making a useful contribution to the learning of young children and teenagers and help us in this cause.

He is the Best Guide and the Best Helper.

World Organization For Islamic Services

(Board of Writing, Translation and Publication)

1st Rabi' ath-Thani 1403

16th January 1983 Tehran, IRAN.

Yazid son of Mu'awiyah

In the Name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful

Yazid was the wicked son of Mu'awiyah who inherited his father's rule. He was the second of the dynastic rulers at the beginning of the Islamic era. His father Mu'awiyah had obtained power over the Muslim community through deceit and treachery. During the last days of his reign he made the people pledge their support for his son Yazid. Thereupon he installed him as his successor at an official ceremony. Yazid's mother was Maysun, who like Hind (notorious for having eaten the liver of Hamzah) was an impure and unchaste woman.

His mother had slept with one of his father's slaves and the despicable, wine-drinking Yazid who was supposed to be the son of Mu'awiyah was really the offspring of that slave.

This has been confirmed by the noble Prophet, Salla 'llahu 'alayhi wa alihi wa sallam (s.a.w.a. — may Allah's peace and blessings be on him and his progeny) who said: "The murderer of my son Husayn, 'alayhi 's-salam (a.s. — peace be upon him), is a bastard" ; which also applies to Shimr, Ibn Sa'd and Ibn Ziyad since all of them were born out of wedlock.

Yazid had inherited all the qualities of his character and way of behaving from his father, Mu'awiyah, all that is, except for one thing: whereas, Mu'awiyah governed by trickery and deceit, compromised with the demands of Islam even to the point of building mosques, Yazid however shamelessly committed the most criminal and despicable acts. Throughout his life and especially during his period of rule, this tyrant, who reigned over the unfortunate unaware Muslims in the name of Islam, became notorious for the following :

1. He owned monkeys which would dance for him dressed in gold- embroidered multi-coloured clothes.
2. His racing dogs were renowned the world over.
3. He was passionately fond of gambling.
4. His addiction to wine set a clear example for his successors.
5. He acted disrespectfully towards the Haram, Mosque of the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) and towards other Mosques of the Muslims.
6. He killed the offspring of the Messenger of Allah (s.a.w.a.) and committed numerous other crimes at

the tragedy of Karbala'.

7. He forced the womenfolk to take off their veils (from both the muhajirun, that is, those who left Mecca for Medina and also from amongst the ansar, that is, those already living in Mecca).

8. He killed countless people of Medina and he and his supporters were responsible for the rape of numerous women of Medina.

9. He arrested and made prisoners the supporters of Ali (a. s.) .

10. He was responsible for damaging the house of Ka'bah and its embroidered covering.

11. He committed many other despic- able crimes which are at least as famous as those we have listed.

Yazid was the first person who made debauchery, rape of women and children, corruption, wine- drinking, music and dancing commonplace behaviour within the Muslims lands. Yazid, in fact was a man who devoted his life to wine- drinking, luxury, indulgence, racing dogs, gambling and rape of women and young girls.

It was Yazid, the so-called caliph of the Muslims who killed the offspring of the Messenger of Allah and their faithful supporters. Immediately after killing Imam Husayn (a.s.) it was this same man who sat back to repose in front of a feast of food and wine, surrounded by musicians, singers and wine-pourers.

Yazid, like his father had done before him, deliberately and openly changed the divine laws to suit his own wishes. He committed such despicable acts during his rule (which lasted only three years and nine months) that he has been cursed by Allah and the people until the end of time.

The most abominable of these was the murdering of Imam Husayn (a.s.), his family and a group of his supporters, during the first year of his rule. He set fire to their tents, tortured the women and baby children and rode over the body of Imam Husayn (a. s.) and others who had died fighting in Allah's way (shuhada') on horseback. Moreover, in the second year of his rule an event known as Harrah took place which was the scene of further bloody atrocities on his part.

Like Mu'awiyah and his bloodthirsty agents, Yazid and his corrupt followers did not shun any criminal act, how-ever disgusting or tyrannical. It was this event which clearly demonstrated to the Muslims and to all men the world over the extent of his corruption and violation of the most basic of human rights.

A group of men from Medina (like others of that time who were forced at spear-point or bribed to make a pledge to Yazid) made their way to visit this so- called 'Muslim' ruler at his place of government in Syria (or more accurately Sham, a country which roughly corresponds to present-day Syria and parts of Lebanon and Palestine).

They were able to see with their own eyes what kind of man was the man who was ruling as a caliph of

Islam, namely a man who loved wine, racing dogs, gambling and a life of ease and luxury and shamelessly violated the honour of men, women and children alike. They returned to Medina in a state of profound unease; when they had told the people of the situation, a large group of men gathered and rose in defiance of the murderous regime.

They expelled the governor of Yazid and his wicked and blood-thirsty agents from Medina.

From this moment onwards the ranks of those rebellions to the government of Yazid grew larger day by day; cries of 'death to Yazid and his corruption' rang out all around Medina.

People spoke out for Islam from the platform (minbar) of the mosques, from the streets and squares, and whenever people would gather together, they courageously declared their opposition to Yazid, saying, "anyone who has killed the progeny of the Messenger of Allah, anyone who drinks wine, does not fast or pray is addicted to gambling and racing dogs, anyone who indulges in luxurious living, dancing and music, anyone who rules corruptly, thinking only of his own interests and never of the poor deprived people — such a man has no right to such a position of power and authority over the Muslims; such a man must step down from his position and make way for another man.

We, Muslims of Medina have pledged our allegiance to a man called Abdullah ibn Hanzalah who is often called Ghasil al-Mala'ikah, we cannot bear to live under the tyranny and corruption of the debauched drunkard Yazid and his agents." News of this rebellion of the Muslims of Medina reached Yazid's ears. Yazid ordered his hated agents to go as soon as possible to the scene of the demonstrations: they were to quell the demonstrators and to stop the cry of those seeking truth and justice from reaching the ears of the rest of the Muslims.

The bloodthirsty Yazid had a man called Muslim ibn 'Uqbah (also known as Mushrif, the wanton spendthrift) brought before him, the latter had been a faithful friend of Yazid's father Mu'awiyah. He dispatched Muslim ibn 'Uqbah at the head of a large army to crush the rebellious Muslims in Medina, after marching for sometime they came to a halt in the rocky area near Medina known as Harrah. The people of Medina set off towards them in order to defend their lives and honour.

In this place known as Harrah a heavy battle took place between the armies of truth and falsehood, many of the Muslims from Medina were killed. The rest were forced to retire, unable to withstand the sheer size and weaponry of this murderous army of Yazid, they took refuge in mosques (including the Holy Prophet's mosque) in order to save their lives. It was the custom in those days to respect the sanctity of mosques, the Haram of the Prophet and large cemeteries, anyone taking refuge then would be safe from any harm.

The people of Medina, under the impression that even the armies of the usurper caliph Yazid would respect this custom took refuge in these places. They did not realize that these were the same godless people who had molested the Prophet, breaking his teeth, throwing dirt on his face and committing countless other despicable acts.

They were the same people who while claiming to be Muslims placed Ali (a. s.) under house arrest, killed his sons and tortured his faithful supporters. It was these same ignorant people who in the name of the Qur'an and claiming to defend the rights of every Muslim, disregarded the divine commandments and made corruption a commonplace in the society of the day.

Muslim ibn 'Uqbah the commander of this army of bloodthirsty men, entered the mosques and the Haram sanctuary of the noble Prophet on horseback in search of those who had sought refuge there, in total violation of the ancient custom they put everyone to the sword, the mosque and the Haram of the noble Messenger (s.a.w.a.) , were drenched in blood.

These godless mercenaries acted as they wished desecrating and ruining these sanctuaries of Islam, they then attacked Medina itself killing countless inhabitants and violating the honour and property of others; even women youths and young children were not spared the slaughter. The murderous commander acting as his master Yazid would have done allowed his army the total freedom of the city for three days; taking advantage of this permission, Yazid's mercenaries gave free rein to their base animal-like instincts. Thousands of women and unmarried girls were raped even within the area of the Prophet's mosque.

These savage godless men acting in accordance with the saying 'the way the common people live is dictated by the behaviour of their kings' imitated the behaviour of Yazid, following the example of their savage, debauched tyrant king they subjected those who had fled to the mosques to unspeakable atrocities.

After the army-commander and his vicious mercenaries had subdued the rebellion of the Muslims by their slaughter and rape of the inhabitants of Medina they forced those who survived the attack to make a pledge of allegiance to Yazid; after exacting this pledge under the threat of death they continued and increased their reign of terror.

A group of the surviving Muslims, fearful for their lives and property, swore an oath of allegiance to Yazid; others however who resisted and refused to accept dictatorial tyranny of Yazid were killed by the savage mercenaries. Such was the reality of what took place at Harrah, just one atrocity among the thousands committed by Yazid in the name of Islam and as a so-called 'Muslim' ruler. Another of the despicable acts Yazid became notorious for, was his destruction and setting fire to mosques.

Abdullah ibn Zubayr was one of the rebellious Muslims, whose independence and determination to secure a true Muslim government caused Yazid considerable trouble; the latter, in order to destroy Abdullah ibn Zubayr and his supporters sent an army commanded by Husayn ibn Namir to Mecca.

The army marched towards Mecca, and came to a halt in the hills overlooking the area of the Ka'bah; they then began to hurl great boulders and fiery missiles from their huge catapults on to the house of the Ka'bah, destroying its walls completely and setting on fire the wooden part of the structure and the embroidered drape-covering; then the barbaric mercenaries of the tyrant Yazid began to attack the town

itself with missiles, staffs, cudgels and swords killing, raping and plundering the inhabitants of Mecca.

The people of Mecca were in desperate situation, there was no way open to them but to entrust their face to Allah and raise their hands in prayer to plead for the death of Yazid. They prayed that Allah may deliver them of this corrupt dictator who was responsible for all the killing and tyranny. It was not long before news reached Mecca of the death of Yazid; the commander of the army and his army of brutal mercenaries returned to Sham and as a result the defense-less people of Mecca were delivered of the merciless attackers.

After three years, nine months and twenty-two days of dictatorial govern- ment Yazid left this world. He died of a kind pleurisy (a serious illness with inflammation of the delicate membrane of the thorax and the lungs, marked by pain in the chest or sides). His grave became a dirty rubbish dump, a fitting end for such tyrant, a fitting end for a man who violated the honour and property of the Muslims, a fitting end for anyone who allows his satanic desires to take precedence over the laws and commandments of Islam and anyone who attempts to change the divine code.

The Second Mu'awiyah, a Flower Flourishes and Blooms in a Heap of Dirt

Before the bloodthirsty wine- drinking traitor Yazid died he obtained for his son Mu'awiyah through menace and bribery a pledge of allegiance from the Muslims. At a special ceremony he declared his son to be his successor after his death. Yazid's son, from his earliest childhood had been trained and educated by a good Muslim teacher, who had faith in Allah, his teacher had told him that his father and father's father had seized power through deceit, treachery and the use of force against the family of the Prophet; they had taken control of the affairs of the government claiming to be the true caliphs of the Muslims.

This conscientious teacher showed Yazid's son the difference between truth and falsehood ; he taught him that only someone who led a perfect life and whose concern was for Islam and for the benefit of the people had a right to the caliphate and the government of the Muslims' affairs; "such persons" he said "were only to be found in the family of the Prophet, that is, Ali and his sons and progeny".

The teacher continued: "If you understand this, then refrain, after the death of your father from taking the reins of government into your hands: Oh son of Yazid, you are responsible in the eyes of Allah and on the Day of Judgement you will be questioned as to your actions in front of all the people. You would be questioned why you accepted government of the Muslims while there existed a man perfectly suited to the position Zaynu 'l-'Abidin, son of Imam Husayn (a.s.). Do you not realize that your father seized

control of the affairs of the Muslims through deceit, treachery and by plotting and threatening?"

These words of the teacher had a profoundly good effect in the heart of this receptive pupil and his love for Ali (a.s.) and hate for his grandfather Mu'awiyah grew increasingly stronger during his period of learning and training. It was for this reason that on the death of the despicable Yazid his son, Mu'awiyah the second succeeded him but remained only forty days in power. Conflicting forces were at work in the heart of Mu'awiyah the second: the forces of truth versus the forces of falsehood.

This inner commotion continued until the day of truth triumphed and he stepped onto the minbar of the mosque to make a speech, after cursing his father and father's father he began, "Oh people. My grandfather, Mu'awiyah made war on the noble Prophet (s.a.w.a.) and Ali (a.s.) and the latter were the most suited to the position of governing the Muslims. Mu'awiyah, through deceit and treacherous scheming usurped the caliphate of the Muslims, which was rightly due to the family of the Prophet. He committed actions during his life which you, better than I, are most familiar with. After Mu'awiyah, my father Yazid seized control of the government, which as before should have been given to the family of the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) . He killed the offspring of the Prophet (s. a. w. a.) and manipulated the divine code of living which is Islam; he committed countless crimes and barbaric atrocities which you are better aware of than I. The truth is that I am ashamed even to speak about them.

"He desecrated the sanctuary of the Haram and the mosque of the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) and destroyed or set fire to other mosques. He violated the honour and the property of the Muslims. I confess I cannot bear to talk about anymore of his horrible actions. Thus I am placing control of affairs into your hands and you are free to choose your owner ruler."

After finishing his speech he returned home and sat crying for a long time. His mother came to him and said: "Oh son, what a pity you did not die in my womb and I did not hear these poisonous words of yours from the very same minbar from which Mu'awiyah and your father used to speak . . ."

Thus she continued until Mu'awiyah the second replied to his mother: "What a pity that I did not die and was not spared the indignity of having a wine-drinking father and a shameless mother."

Mu'awiyah lived only a few days longer, dying at the age of twenty-two. After his death, Mu'awiyah's teacher, who was responsible for awakening the conscience of Yazid's son, was buried alive.

They realized that it was he who influenced Mu'awiyah the second and had taught him the truth about Islam. Although the influence of the teacher on Mu'awiyah's spirit and intellect was considerable, it was not the ultimate cause of his abandoning the position of caliphate.

There was another more important reason; one day while the son of Yazid was sitting deeply in thought in his home he heard the raised voices of two slave-girls conversing with each other. One of them had turned to the other who was the more beautiful and charming, saying: "Your beauty is the cause of the pride and arrogance of the Sultans."

The beautiful slave girl replied: "What better Sultanate exists than the rule of beauty and charm? — No king in his arrogance can refuse the request of a beautiful woman; thus I hold sway over all the kings of the world."

The other slave girl said: "What I ask you, is the good in being a power ruler: every king who wishes to fulfill his duty and responsibility towards the people cannot expect to live a life of ease and comfort. If however a king wants to spend his life in luxury, easy living indulgence in sensual pleasure and debauchery then he has mined his claim to kingship and has failed to fulfill his duty towards the people. He will be responsible before Allah and the people: his place will be in hell and he will not be spared the punishment of Allah. Thus we can see that sultans and kings cannot enjoy both this world and the next."

The slave girl's words affected the heart of Yazid's son and consequently he abandoned the sultanate and delivered himself of its heavy responsibilities and Allah's punishment in the next world.

Source URL: <https://www.al-islam.org/yazid-son-muawiyah-and-his-son-historical-stories-children-2>

Links

- [1] <https://www.al-islam.org/organization/world-organization-islamic-services-wofis-0>
- [2] <https://www.al-islam.org/printpdf/book/export/html/42192>
- [3] <https://www.al-islam.org/printepub/book/export/html/42192>
- [4] <https://www.al-islam.org/printmobi/book/export/html/42192>
- [5] <https://www.al-islam.org/tags/history>
- [6] <https://www.al-islam.org/person/yazid-b-muawiya>